

Proposal Evaluation Form

	EUROPEAN COMMISSION	Evaluation Summary Report
	Erasmus+ (ERASMUS+)	

Call: ERASMUS-YOUTH-2025-YOUTH-TOG
Type of action: ERASMUS-LS
Proposal number: 101246479
Proposal acronym: FOCUS
Duration (months): 24
Proposal title: FOCUS – Framing Our Civic Unity for Sustainable Development Goals
Activity: ERASMUS-YOUTH-2025-YOUTH-TOG

N.	Proposer name	Country	Total eligible costs	%	Grant Requested	%
1	PLATAFORMA DE ALTERNATIVAS SOSTENIBLES Y SOLIDARIAS PASOS	ES	82,475	20.62%	82,475	20.62%
2	ASSOCIACAO EDUCATIVA NACIONAL DE INCLUSAO E INOVAÇÃO NAS ESCOLAS	PT	80,374	20.09%	80,374	20.09%
3	ORIEL APS	IT	78,452	19.61%	78,452	19.61%
4	YOUTH FOR EXCHANGE AND UNDERSTANDING INTERNATIONAL AISBL	BE	79,950	19.99%	79,950	19.99%
5	EQuality	PL	78,748	19.69%	78,748	19.69%
Total:			399,999		399,999	

Abstract:

The project FOCUS - Framing Our Civic Unity for Sustainable Development Goals, aims to empower young people to actively engage in their communities by fostering entrepreneurship and aligning their efforts with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

*Objectives and WPs:

O1 (Objective 1): To guarantee effective project management, clear governance, comprehensive financial oversight, and risk mitigation

WP1: Project Coordination and Management

O2: To equip youth workers and young people with skills in digital entrepreneurship and employability

WP2: Equipping Youth Workers and Young People with Digital Entrepreneurship Skills

O3: To create a strong youth network that fosters leadership, digital communication, and activism

WP3: Youth Network for Leadership, Digital Communication, and Activism

O4: To provide young people with a platform to express civic engagement using photography and debate

WP4: Civic Engagement through Photography and Debate

O5: To empower youth to conduct research on SDG-related challenges, develop policy proposals, and present them in Brussels

WP5: SDGs in Perspective – Research, Debate, and Policy Advocacy

O6: To ensure quality assessment, visibility, and long-term sustainability of the project

WP6: Evaluation Strategies, Visibility, and Sustainability

Evaluation Summary Report

Evaluation Result

Total score: 53.00 (Threshold: 60)

Criterion 1 - RELEVANCE

Score: **15.00** (Threshold: 15 / 30.00 , Weight: -)

The detailed criteria are set out in the call conditions (see Call document).

The proposal is overall relevant to the call promoting youth empowerment. However, there is no sufficient information specifying how the proposal establishes and develops an EU added value that supports policies at EU level relevant for youth – most notably the EU Youth Strategy 2019-2027. The project mentions that it builds upon the legacy of the European Year of Youth 2022, but more information about that is not provided in sufficient detail.

Through its educational content and interactive methodologies, the project is fundamentally aligned to promote the core values of the European Union, but this point is insufficiently elaborated.

The project objectives are linked to the specific objectives of the call, measurable, and relevant to the target groups. Yet some of them overlap with certain elements that are considered more transversal project activities, such as project coordination and management, evaluation strategies, visibility and sustainability of the project. While the objectives are relevant for young people as a whole, the target group is not sufficiently defined, as it generally addresses motivated young people without giving sufficient information about their background.

The proposal includes a description of the general societal challenges addressed, with limited data for each country, and without an adequate analysis of the resulting needs of young people or youth workers disaggregated by country. The needs of each partner organisation are very briefly described, without giving adequate detail or examples. Country examples given for the described challenges do not always justifiably support these challenges. This is for example the case for the challenge of lack of green initiatives, with the provided country data only informing about entrepreneurship in general.

The proposal includes a high number of young people throughout most activities, which is in line with the project objectives. However, it is not clear whether young people have been involved in the project design. The proposal does not adequately include young people with fewer opportunities as a specific target group. Participants will be selected based on their motivation, and obstacles to the participation of young people with fewer opportunities have not been sufficiently addressed.

Criterion 2.1 - QUALITY - PROJECT DESIGN AND IMPLEMENTATION

Score: **13.00** (Threshold: 15 / 30.00 , Weight: -)

The detailed criteria are set out in the call conditions (see Call document).

The workplan includes appropriate phases for preparation, implementation and monitoring, and review and evaluation. The work packages and the activities are described in detail.

A major shortcoming of the project is the wide scope and generic nature of its objectives and activities, which leads to a limited logical structure of the project plan. It is, for example, not sufficiently clear how the framework for essential approaches to digital entrepreneurship and career development will be used in the training course for youth workers, and how the local workshops will built upon the training content for youth workers. There is also no sufficient link between the youth exchange and the volunteering activity and the local workshops. While all activities are framed around addressing the Sustainable Development Goals, also a logical flow between the research and photo competition and the previous activities is not sufficiently described. The activities do not necessarily include the same participants, and the content of one activity is not convincingly used in another. There is an adequate link between the identified needs, project objectives and individual activities proposed, but there are several inconsistencies in the description of the methodology. While the methodology of some activities, such as the training courses, is very well described and suitable for the target group, others are inadequately described. For example, the approaches for digital entrepreneurship and career development are described in detail, but the corresponding deliverable only has a small number of pages, which is not consistent given the content described in the methodology. The local trainings for young people as a follow up to the youth workers training course are also inadequately described. It is not sufficiently explained how the workshops will improve digital and employability skills of young people, when each workshop will focus on one specific Sustainable Development Goals, as described in the task list. The methodology of the volunteering activity is also not sufficiently described, and lacks clarity about the activities the volunteers will be involved in and the support they will receive. It is also not clear how the young people will be supported in the youth research on the SDGs. The proposal foresees adequate quantitative indicators, but does not sufficiently address qualitative aspects through its indicators, such as quality of the training courses and results. The proposal mentions quality control, risk management and conflict escalation process, but does not give sufficient detail on these foreseen mechanism. While the risks and mitigation measures mentioned are realistic, the list is not sufficiently exhaustive, as it excludes significant risks such as low engagement of policy-makers, or not enough entries into the photo competition.

The proposed budget is coherent and proportionate to the number of participating organisations, volume and type of activities. The budget is equally distributed among the partners in relations to their tasks and responsibilities. However, the cost-efficiency of the budget is not sufficiently justified (e.g. the three project meetings in person, the high number of person-months). In addition, given that the volunteering activity is not convincingly described as adding significant value to the project, the high budget necessary is not justified. Management, coordination and staff costs are proportionate to the size of the project. It is not adequate that staff costs are the same between all partners, even though salary costs vary significantly between, for example, Belgium and Poland. Distributing the same number of units for each partner under the same work package is not justified, as coordinators or event hosts will have a higher workload than others will. The units used are not person months, but working days.

Criterion 2.2 - QUALITY - PARTNERSHIP AND COOPERATION ARRANGEMENTS

Score: **16.00** (Threshold: 10 / 20.00 , Weight: -)

The detailed criteria are set out in the call conditions (see the Call document).

The partnership includes an appropriate mix of complementary organisations. The involvement of a European network, one newer grassroots youth organisation with little experience so far, and three more experienced local and national organisations working with young people, is very suitable for the general objectives of this call. Their competencies match the project objectives adequately, as they include experience with entrepreneurship, youth participation, volunteerism and cultural activities. The partners are adequately described.

With only five countries and partners involved and three of them from Southern Europe, the partnership is geographically not adequately balanced.

Besides the youth worker training, NGO development is not an objective of this project and peer learning mechanisms are not explicitly built into the proposal. However, through very regular coordination meetings, including face-to-face meetings, it is expected that the smaller, less experienced NGOs in the partnership will be able to learn from the more experienced partners.

The distribution of tasks between the partners is clearly described, with every partner implementing the same local activities, and each partner being responsible for the coordination of at least one work package. It is not adequately explained how YEU, as European network, will implement the local activities, as their local activities are not sufficiently addressed in the partner description. The coordinator has sufficient experience in coordinating similar projects and is suitable for coordinating a network of this size.

The consortium sets an effective and flexible management structure with steering committee, partnership agreement. The proposal clearly describes the main instruments to be used for coordination and communication between the participating organisations, as well as with other relevant stakeholders, which is valuable. Moreover, the consortium clearly sets coordination and communication methods through regular online meetings with partner organisations and communication channels. Conflict resolution mechanisms are foreseen to be set up only during the implementation, which is a small shortcoming.

Criterion 3 - IMPACT

Score: **9.00** (Threshold: 10 / 20.00 , Weight: -)

The detailed criteria are set out in the call conditions (see the Call document).

The proposal clearly introduces the overall approach to the monitoring and evaluation processes, including gathering feedback from participants and conducting surveys and engagement metrics. The impact on participants and partner organizations and other stakeholders is presented in general without giving details in the short term and after the project lifetime. Moreover, not all foreseen impact is credibly linked to project activities. For example, the proposal foresees a positive impact on youth workers through accessing more funding and institutional backing, which is not credibly backed up by any foreseen activity or objective. Another example is the expected impact on the partnership to have created structured and inclusive youth participation mechanisms, which is also not adequately supported by a corresponding activity. The impact foreseen for outside of the organizations and participants involved in the project is not described in sufficient depth. Potential barriers to the expected outcomes and impacts have not been adequately identified, and potential negative impacts have not been sufficiently addressed. One work package focuses on evaluation and dissemination, satisfactorily including several impact assessments and credible measures for evaluating outcomes. The proposal suggests a sustainability strategy, but it contains several shortcomings. For example, workshops mentioned to keep youth workers up to date with latest methodologies has not been adequately included in the work plan. Funding sources for a continuation of the partnership have not been adequately identified beyond the possibility to apply for future EU funding. Synergies with other EU funded projects have been identified as potential for sustainability, but without making sufficient links to any concrete projects.

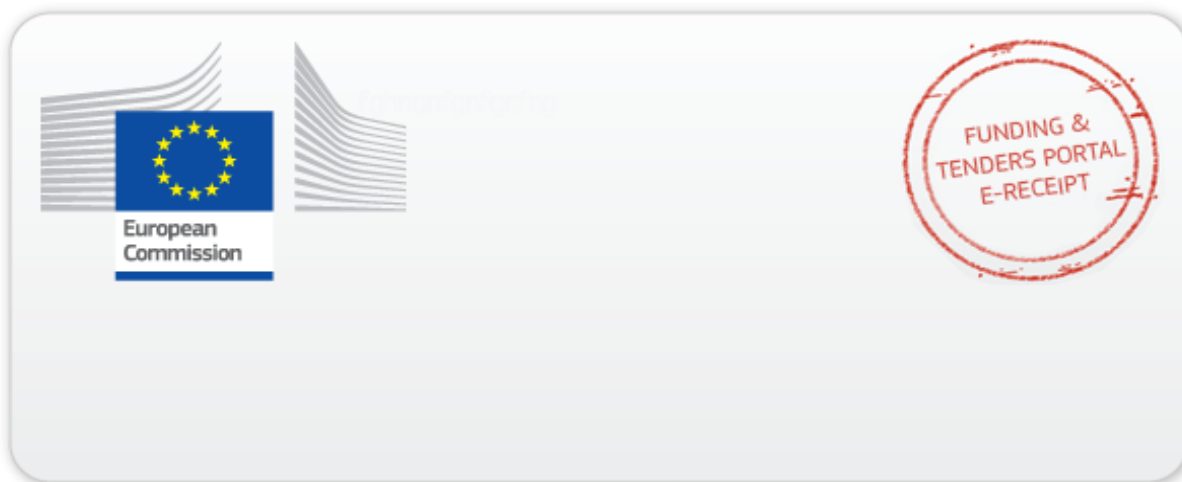
The proposal includes a generic communication and dissemination plan, listing a number of communication and dissemination channels and target groups without adequate focus, and without identifying key messages. Several channels are not fully appropriate given the project activities, for example foreseen publications in research and industry journals. The description of the work package covering communication and dissemination suggests activities different than foreseen in the communication strategy. Project results will be made publicly and freely available on the project website.

Scope of the proposal

Status: **Yes**

Comments (in case the proposal is out of scope)

Not provided



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